LS3: COMMUNICATION

COMMUNICATION: Emails

Situation: You are getting work experience at HardWareHouse Ltd, an IT hardware wholesaler. Your supervisor asks you to take care of a customer enquiry.
→ You write an email to a customer.

1 Giving email addresses over the phone

You check the English for some of the symbols that appear in email addresses.

A Match the symbols (1–6) to the words (a–f).

1 +	4 -	a at	d plus
2 _	5 .	b dot	e number
3 @	6 3	c hyphen	f underscore

16 **B Listen to your supervisor and a customer on the phone. Which email addresses are correct?**

1	2
a tm.martin@hard_warehouse.nex	a maryannbrown@5+5_services.ger
b tmmartin@hardware-house.nex	b mary-anne-brown@5+5services.ger
c tm.martin@hardware_house.nex	c maryann-brown@5+5services.ger

C Work with a partner. You are going to dictate email addresses to each other.

Partner A: Look at File 2 on page 134.
Partner B: Look at File 4 on page 135.

Can you spell that, please?

Could you repeat that, please?

2 Writing a subject line

The first indication of what is in an email is the subject line. This must state clearly what the email is about.

A Work with a partner. Study the subject lines (1–6) below and find an email which …

1 is a request for information.	a Subject: Need your help with English
2 gives information about a meeting.	b Subject: New venue for event on Saturday
3 asks for assistance.	c Subject: Flyer (attached)
4 contains new information.	d Subject: Meeting 25.03. Starting time?
5 announces a change of plan.	e Subject: Update on project
6 is a covering letter for a brochure	f Subject: Agenda

B With your partner, write suitable subject lines for the following emails (1–6).

1 Sorry, I would like to change the date of the meeting to Friday 12 July.
2 Could you send me information about the presentation, please?
3 I am on holiday from 21.03 till 04.04 inclusive and will answer emails when I return.
4 I am writing to confirm your application for a stand at the Technical Trades Fair. The stand number is C208.
5 As promised, here is the link to the website www.tipsformails.com.
6 This is just to let you know that I am interviewing a new technician at 12.30.

TOOLBOX

hyphen – *Bindestrich, Minus*
underscore – *Unterstrich*

3 Writing a reply to an email enquiry

Your supervisor gives you the enquiry below and asks you to reply by email.

Dear Sir or Madam
We have studied your catalogue on the internet and are interested in your ergonomic mouse devices (catalogue number SP 492876) and your keyboards (catalogue number SS 8592201).
We would like to order 100 of each item.
We would also like to order 200 8 GB USB sticks and 200 16 GB USB sticks.
Please let us know if you have these items in stock.

Yours faithfully
Robert Johnson
CompuStore Ltd

Use a suitable greeting and subject line and reply to Mr Johnson. Include the following points:

- Thank him for his enquiry.
- Say that the mouse devices, keyboards and USB sticks are in stock.
- Say you will dispatch them next week.
- Say that you look forward to doing business with him in the future.
- Use the correct complimentary close.

› *Useful phrases: Writing emails, page 156*

Using polite language in emails

Could and *would like* are more polite than phrases with *can, need* or *want*.
~~Can~~ you let me know by Monday? → **Could** you let …
I ~~need~~ the information today. → I **would like** the …
We ~~want~~ to have a meeting. → We **would like** to …

› *Grammar: Modals and their substitutes, page 169*

Salutation and complimentary close in emails

If you do not know the name of the person you are writing to, begin your email with *Dear Sir or Madam*.
If you do not know your business partner well, use a formal salutation and complimentary close.

	Salutation	Complimentary close	
Formal (to an unknown person)	Dear Sir or Madam	Yours faithfully	
Formal (to a person whose name you know)	Dear Mr/Ms Smith	Regards Best regards	Best wishes Yours sincerely
Less formal	Dear Paul / Hi Paula Good morning, Paul	Regards Best regards	Best wishes All the best

DAS KANN ICH (Unit 4)

- Bei einem täglichen Teamtreffen über den Verlauf meiner Arbeit berichten. (Foundation)
- Die Erfordernisse für ein neues Netzwerk auf Englisch erklären. (Part A)
- Englischsprachige Kollegen/Kolleginnen überzeugen, eine Cloud-Lösung einzuführen. (Part B)
- Die E-Mail eines Kunden / einer Kundin auf Englisch beantworten. (Communication)

TOOLBOX

complimentary close – *Grußformel (am Briefende)*
salutation – *Anrede*
subject line – *Betreff*
Best regards / Regards – *Viele Grüße / Mit freundlichen Grüßen*
Yours faithfully – *Mit freundlichen Grüßen*
Yours sincerely – *Mit freundlichen Grüßen*

2 Produktion: B1

Sie sind Praktikant/in bei T&P in Luton, UK, einem Unternehmen mit Schwerpunkt Business Software für mittelständische Unternehmen. Ihr Vorgesetzter bittet Sie, neue Laptops bei der Firma DIY Hardware zu bestellen. Sie sollen aber vorher einen Kostenvoranschlag (*quotation*) für einen Laptop einholen, den Sie für die Softwareentwicklung für geeignet halten.

Verfassen Sie eine E-Mail an DIY Hardware in englischer Sprache unter Berücksichtigung folgender Punkte:

- förmliche Anrede
- Informationen über Ihre Firma
- Angebot über einen Laptop Ihrer Wahl
- Konfiguration – geeignet für Software-Entwickler
- Frage nach Rabatt bei Bestellung von fünf Geräten
- Frage nach der Lieferzeit und Verfügbarkeit
- Grußformel

3 Produktion: B2

Sie sind Praktikant/in bei T&P. Sie beantworten per E-Mail die Fragen Ihres englischen Freundes, der Probleme mit seinem langsamen Computer hat.

Schreiben Sie ihm eine E-Mail in englischer Sprache unter Berücksichtigung folgender Punkte:

- Bezug auf die E-Mail Ihres Freundes
- Entfernung von Datenmüll
- Gewinnung von Speicherplatz
- Endgültiges Löschen von Dateien (Shreddern oder Deinstallieren?)
- Programme zur Beschleunigung des PC
- Datensicherheit bei häufigem Surfen im Internet
- freundschaftlicher Abschluss

Email Section	Useful Expressions
Opening / Greeting	- Dear [Name],- Hello [Name],- Good morning/afternoon [Name],- To whom it may concern,
Reference / Context	- I am writing regarding…- Further to our conversation…- With reference to…- I am contacting you about…
Purpose / Main Point	- I would like to inform you that…- I am pleased to announce…- I am reaching out to request…- Could you please confirm…
Polite Requests	- Could you kindly…- I would appreciate it if you could…- Would you mind…- Please let me know if…
Offering Help	- Please do not hesitate to contact me if…- I would be happy to assist with…- Let me know if you need any further information.
Apologies	- I apologize for the inconvenience.- Please accept my apologies for…- Sorry for the delay in responding.
Closing (Action)	- I look forward to your reply.- I await your confirmation.- Thank you in advance for your cooperation.
Sign-off	- Best regards,- Kind regards,- Sincerely,- Yours faithfully, (formal, when recipient unknown)

Writing emails	**Unit 4**
Salutation	
– Dear Sir or Madam (*formal*)	– *Sehr geehrte Damen und Herren,*
– Dear Mr/Ms Smith (*formal*)	– *Sehr geehrte/r Herr/Frau Schmidt,*
– Dear Paul (und Paula)	– *Lieber Paul(, Liebe Paula)*
– Good morning, Paul (*less formal*)	– *Guten Morgen, Paul,*
– Hi/Hello Paula (*less formal*)	– *Hallo Paula,*
Complimentary close	
– Yours faithfully (*formal*)	– *Mit freundlichen Grüßen*
– Regards / Best regards / Best wishes / Yours sincerely (*formal*)	– *Mit freundlichen Grüßen / Freundliche Grüße*
– Regards / Best regards / Best wishes	– *Viele Grüße / Freundlichen Grüße*
– All the best (*less formal*)	– *Alles Gute / Herzliche Grüße*
Opening sentence	
– I'm just writing to … (*formal*)	– *Ich schreibe Ihnen, … zu …*
– Just a quick note/message to … (*less formal*)	– *Nur eine kurze Mitteilung/Nachricht, … zu …*
Conclusion	
– I look forward to your reply / to hearing from you. (*formal*)	– *Ich freue mich auf Ihre Antwort.*
– Many thanks in advance. (*formal*)	– *Vielen Dank im Voraus.*
– I hope to hear from you soon. (*less formal*)	– *Ich freue mich, bald von Ihnen/Dir zu hören.*

PART A: Installing a new network

Situation: You are a network engineer at Jupa Engineering, an engineering company in Dublin. The company is expanding and is about to move to the fourth floor of a new office building.
→ **You write an email to a colleague explaining the requirements for a new network.**

1 Explaining wireless network design to a colleague

You are on the new floor with your colleague Michael Kaeding and the project manager in charge of the move, Simon Smith. Michael is explaining some important considerations for the new network to Simon.

14 A **Listen to the conversation and note down what the following numbers refer to.**

1 €20,000
2 220
3 660 to 880
4 2.4GhZ / 5GHz
5 2800m²
6 100Mbps

Infobox

latency – the time it takes for data to travel from the source to the destination in a network
OFDMA (**Orthogonal Frequency-Division Multiple Access**) – a multi-user version of the popular Orthogonal Frequency-Division Multiplexing (OFDM), used in wireless communication
MU-MIMO (**Multi-User, Multiple Input, Multiple Output**) – allows multiple devices to receive data simultaneously from a Wi-Fi router
APs (**Access Points**) – devices that allow wireless devices, like laptops or smartphones, to connect to a wired network by broadcasting a Wi-Fi signal
SSIDs (**Service Set Identifiers**) – unique names given to wireless networks (Wi-Fi networks) to distinguish them from others

14 B **Listen again and complete the statements about the things the network design needs to consider.**

1 We're setting up a business network here, so we need to ___ like load, coverage, and reliability ___ .
2 We've ___ the bandwidth demands for all of that.
3 Future-proofing the network is key, ___ equipment that can scale and continue delivering.
4 To avoid that, we ___ a Wi-Fi 6 setup.
5 We'll definitely want a few spares, but ___ that overloading the space with access points can create interference.
6 We'll need to ___ there's minimal interference.
7 We'll need to ___ the building materials.

Taking things into consideration

So we need to **take** many things **into account**.
We'll need to **factor in** the building materials.
Bear in mind that it can quickly become expensive.
We should consider an increase in employees.

› *Useful phrases: Explaining requirements and consequences, page 155*

2 Explaining consequences

Simon sends an email to you the following day, as your colleague Michael is out of the office.

From: s.smith@jupa.nex
To: networkservices@jupa.nex
Subject: Network budget estimate

Hi
I've checked Michael's budget estimate with prices online and it looks as if the final cost is likely to be about €25,000. So we need to be able to justify the extra €5K over the current budget.
Below is a draft of what I'm going to send to Finance for approval. I've tried to explain the need for the extra money and point out the consequences of not making the investment. I think this will get their attention!
Could you add any additional information and justifications that you think are necessary?
Could you get this back to me by midday tomorrow?
Simon

- It's crucial that we purchase at least 12 access points to cover the floor area. The consequence of having fewer access points is the increased risk of slower speeds.
- Having both a 2.4 and 5 GHz band network is a high priority. Failure to invest in these mean network performance and employee productivity will suffer.
- It's vital that we invest in a wireless network that can handle the expected load increase over the next five years. Most devices only connect wirelessly and this will increase over time. It'll be cheaper to invest wisely now as we will get a bulk discount.
- As our testing equipment is quite old, we need a Wi-Fi strength measurement unit to test that the network is usable all over the floor. We'll be guessing the signal strength if we don't replace this equipment, and this could lead to coverage gaps on the floor.

A **First, read Simon's email and make notes on the points on the right.**

- *What's the problem?*
- *Who needs to approve?*
- *How to get their attention?*
- *What do I need to do?*
- *By when?*

B **Work with a partner. Read the email again and point out the consequences of not investing properly in the project now. Answer your partner's questions. Change roles when you have finished.**

1 Why can't we purchase fewer access points?
2 Can't we buy cheaper single-band routers?
3 Why can't we just buy enough to get started?
4 Can't we use our old Wi-Fi strength measurement unit

Expressing consequences

We **will increase** the risk of slower speeds if we **don't buy** enough access points.
Unless we **install** a dual-band network, employee productivity **will suffer**.

› *Grammar: Conditional sentences, page 166*

3 Writing an email reply

You reply to your colleague Simon Smith with a few extra points to justify the amount of money you are asking for.

A **For each of the requirements in the table below, make statements to express how important it is. Use the words and phrases in the list to help you.**

absolutely critical · crucial · extremely important · high priority · vital

Requirements	*Consequences*
Four spare access points: · *access points can fail; need four spares now* · *need hardware we know works* · *need to test properly after installation to find weak signal spots*	· *lose productivity* · *can't guarantee compatibility with current network* · *need to install more access points later at a higher price*
Business-grade router: · *need shielded business-grade router* · *has to be able to handle business load*	· *corrupted data from interference* · *lower speeds and less productivity*

As access points can fail, it's vital that we buy four spare ones now.

B **Now write the email, using the consequences in the list above to strengthen your arguments for extra funding.**

Hi Simon
Here are a few additional arguments you can provide:
Four spare access points
As access points can fail, it's vital … . If we don't do that now, we …

› *Useful phrases: Writing emails, page 156*

4 Thinking about consequences

At your home or job you are likely to use a network for your computing. Both of these networks have different needs because they are used differently.

Discuss the following questions with a partner.

– Who uses your home or work network and what are they used for?
– What considerations are important when creating a network?
– What are the consequences of poor/cheap equipment?

Here are some ideas to get you started:

– How many devices do you access the network with?
– How big is your home/work area?
– How many people use the network?
– What high volume/bandwidth activities is the network used for?
– Are there many other routers around that could cause interference?

› *Useful phrases: Explaining requirements and consequences, page 155*

PROJECT

Using wireless networks
Given the capabilities of 5G and satellite internet, plan a meeting with your boss to argue for not investing in a cabled network for the workplace and using wireless instead. Research the follow points and make notes or create an agenda for the meeting:
– deployment speed & lower upfront costs
– scalability & flexibility
– high speeds & reliability
– future-proofing & reduced maintenance

Role-play the meeting with a partner.

2 Arguing the case for a particular option

You receive a response from a department lead.

I appreciate the thorough analysis you've provided. Even though our previous solutions have served us adequately, I believe exploring cloud infrastructure could greatly benefit our organization.

Cloud services offer unparalleled scalability, allowing us to align resources precisely with our performance expectations. That said, there may be some reluctance within the team to move away from familiar systems, which we need to address through proper training and change management.

Despite concerns about data security, reputable cloud providers implement robust measures to protect our intellectual property, which is mandatory under GDPR compliance.

Trusting sensitive information to third parties carries risks, and we must ensure that data processing remains in compliant locations to avoid legal problems. Even so, cloud providers are experts and deal with it every day.

Although cloud infrastructure can significantly boost productivity by enabling seamless access to data and applications from any location, there is the potential for excessive latency, especially if data centres are geographically distant. This could impede application performance and negatively impact user experience.

How quickly we can implement disaster recovery – in whatever form – is one area I still have questions about. Having said that, cloud allows us to quickly replicate our data across different regions, protecting it from localized disasters like fires, floods, or earthquakes.

Related to the above point is the biggest concern of handing over control of our infrastructure to another company. I agree that this is a hurdle, but many large and well-respected companies already trust cloud providers, which tell me that this is something we can overcome

The uptake of cloud solutions among global enterprises indicates a strong trend toward embracing these technologies. Even though challenges exist, I believe that, with the right focus, we can mitigate risks associated with data security and compliance.

A **Read the email on page 42. Then copy the table below and summarize the arguments in favour of and the concerns about moving to cloud. There are six pairs of arguments all together. The first one has been done for you.**

Cloud Infrastructure	
Arguments in favour	Concerns
cloud services offer unparalleled scalability	*there may be some reluctance within the team to move away from familiar systems*

B **Use the words provided to help you acknowledge the counterarguments while stating your case. The first one has been done for you**

1 Even though …
Even though there may be some reluctance within the team to move away from familiar systems, I believe cloud services offer unparalleled scalability.
2 Despite …
3 Although …
4 Nevertheless, …
5 That said, …
6 Even though …

Acknowledging counterarguments

Despite being great in theory, previous solutions have not worked.
Big companies will benefit most. **That said**, all companies can benefit.
Solutions have come and gone. **Nevertheless**, I think the time has come for a change.

› *Useful phrases: Taking part in discussions, page 156*